notably SauceLabs contract testing (https://mng.bz/n0OK), Testsigma CDCT (https://mng.bz/r1RX), or ContractCase contracts by example (https://case.contract-testing.io/). Within this section, we touch on a few of the popular ones, which should cover the tools most people are using:

- Pact in the language of your choice (Java virtual machine [JVM] languages, Go, JavaScript, Python, .NET, PHP, Rust, and more)
- Spring Cloud Contract
- Postman
- JSON Schema (schema validation only)

Including schema validation presents the opportunity to compare the differences between schema validation and contract testing. The preceding list is incomplete; as mentioned, other tools/frameworks are available, but these are the ones we most commonly hear about.

3.6.1 Contract-based tools

Contract testing tools don't just offer the framework for creating and verifying contracts. They have an infrastructure for storing contracts and communicating with the broker to enable running in CI systems. Therefore, when considering which contract testing tool to choose, consider the whole end-to-end process and how the tool would fit into your existing infrastructure.

Choosing a tool depends on which language you use to develop the frontend and backend applications and what approach you want to take to start contract testing. As always, when deciding what tool to use for a specific task, such as evaluating open source test automation frameworks, there are many factors to consider. It's not just about the tool's performance but you must also consider community support when you need help. Another factor to consider is the learning curve required to train the team.

In a scenario where there may be an existing tool such as Postman that's already familiar to the team, it can be adapted to follow the contract testing process. A current tool could be the right choice while showing the value to